CLASS 9 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The paradox 'to fail is to learn' is consistent with the unit because: 1

(a) failure is rare
(b) failure is good in itself
(c) failure gives experience that builds success
(d) failure is shameful

2. The word 'aspiration' is closest to: 1

(a) loss **(b)** ambition **(c)** fear **(d)** rest

3. Which of these is the best inference about Ming's state of mind? 1

(a) she is excited but uncertain **(b)** she is hopeless
(c) she is fearless **(d)** she is angry

4. A 'comfort zone' differs from a 'safe zone' in that comfort zone: 1

(a) is unreal **(b)** is a place
(c) is dangerous **(d)** limits growth though it feels safe

5. Which statement is a rhetorical question? 1

(a) Where is Ming? **(b)** Did she write?
(c) What time is it? **(d)** Who would not want to follow a dream?

6. A critic says the letter is conservative. A fair reply is that it: 1

(a) forbids dreams
(b) encourages bold dreaming while insisting on realism
(c) ignores Ming
(d) mocks effort

7. Which pair best shows the unit's central tension? 1

(a) security vs aspiration **(b)** rich vs poor
(c) day vs night **(d)** town vs village

8. Which of the following is a counterexample to 'only the talented succeed'? 1

(a) a lazy genius
(b) a persistent learner who masters a skill by practice
(c) a lost map
(d) a sudden win

9. Which sentence best captures the paradox of the letter? 1

(a) to be free to follow a dream, one must bind oneself to discipline
(b) cost is nothing
(c) dreams are easy
(d) effort is useless

10. Which rhetorical technique would be most effective in a speech on this theme? 1

(a) numbers only
(b) repetition of a call such as 'Take the step!'
(c) slang
(d) silence

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. What does the letter suggest about the relation between passion and discipline? 2

12. Compare the audiences addressed by the letter and the poem. 2

13. Why might a mother's advice be more persuasive than an expert's? 2

14. Examine the use of the imperative 'Step up' as a heading. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Analyse the significance of the letter form for the theme. 3

16. Does a motivational poem romanticise challenges? Discuss. 3

17. Argue for or against: 'Dreams should be practical.' 3

OR

Discuss whether the mother's advice is gender-neutral. 3

18. Rewrite as a conditional: 'Ming did not plan, so she struggled.' 3

OR

How are persistence and flexibility connected in the unit? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Examine how the letter combines emotion and logic. 5

OR

Write a letter from a mentor to a student who wants to become an artist or scientist. 5

20. Write an essay (about 150 words) on 'Why many dreams remain unfulfilled', using the letter. 5

OR

Write a short story (about 120 words) about a girl who takes the first step towards a difficult goal. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks